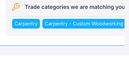
Dashboard(Responsive) Audit

Issue Type	Problem	Criticality	Screenshot	Proposed Solution
Onboarding UX	Zero-state dashboard shows no onboarding guidance. New employers see raw '0' counters and red-diamond error alerts with no setup flow or progress bar.	Critical		Replace error alerts with a numbered onboarding checklist. Add progress bar, convert warnings to friendly info icons, celebrate first completion with success state.
Modal Interaction	Dropdown in 'Add New Skill' modal overflows outside the modal boundary onto the dimmed overlay, breaking visual containment.	Critical		Modal should dynamically increase height to contain the dropdown, or render inline-expanding list within modal body. Set overflow: visible on inner container only.
Scrollability / Affordance	Dropdown in modal shows only 4 trade categories with no scroll affordance. Users have no indication more content exists below.	Critical		Add scrollbar
Modal Interaction	When dropdown is open, Confirm/Cancel buttons are hidden behind it. Users cannot save without closing the dropdown first, which is non-obvious.	Critical		Action buttons must remain visible. Add sticky footer or fix modal height so buttons are always shown. Add 'Done selecting' affordance inside the dropdown.
Empty State Design	All 3 KPI cards show '0' in the same large bold black number with no visual differentiation. They don't communicate being unstarted states.	Critical		Show '0' in muted secondary color. Add micro-copy nudging action (e.g. 'Post a job to get applications'). Use colored icon banners to differentiate card purpose.
Button / Control Labeling	The action button inside the dropdown is truncated/cut off on the right side. Button text is not readable and action is completely ambiguous.	Critical		Ensure action button is fully visible within dropdown bounds. Label explicitly ('Clear all' or 'Deselect all'). Provide enough padding so it is never clipped.
Platform Feature — Notifications	No notification bell, no alert tray, no badge counter exists anywhere. For a hiring/matching platform, time-sensitive alerts are core to value proposition.	Critical		Add notification bell with unread badge in top nav. Clicking opens dropdown tray with recent alerts and timestamps. Add in-app toast notifications.
Responsive Layout / Mobile UX	On Mobile, KPI cards switch to vertically stacked layout where icon banner expands into massive full-width block, forcing excessive scrolling.	Critical		On mobile, convert KPI cards into compact horizontal cards with icon left and metric details right. Icon size should never exceed 48px on mobile.
Mobile Navigation UX	On 425px, mobile nav drawer opens almost full-screen but lacks close affordance. No visible close button and no dimmed backdrop for outside-tap dismissal.	Critical		Add visible close (X) button inside drawer header. Ensure hamburger trigger remains accessible.
Responsive Layout / Mobile UX	On Mobile, section title text wraps across multiple lines while Edit action detaches and floats below as a centred icon-only control, becoming visually disconnected.	Critical		On mobile, restructure into vertical layout with title text on top and clearly labeled full-width 'Edit Categories' button below. Avoid isolated icon-only actions.
Information Architecture	No top navigation bar exists. The UI relies entirely on sidebar nav, which leaves no persistent space for utility actions like search, notifications, or user profile.	Medium		Add a top nav bar spanning the full width.
Visual Design Depth & Elevation	Dashboard cards and panels sit on a flat gray background with no consistent shadow or elevation system. Layers feel undifferentiated.	Medium		Define a 3-tier elevation system background, card, modal/overlay. Apply consistently.
Empty State Design	The 'Success Center' section title and content appear even when empty, showing only error states — no positive success states, no completion animation.	Medium		When all items are resolved, transform to a positive success state: green checkmark animation, 'You're all set!' heading, remove the error icon pattern.
Iconography Consistency	Sidebar uses mixed icon styles — some outlined, some filled, varying stroke weights. The 'Logout' icon is noticeably different in weight from the rest.	Medium		Standardize on a single icon library and weight. Audit all icons against a single style spec.
Typography Scale	Body copy, labels, and card metrics share too similar a type size. The visual hierarchy between supporting text and primary data is weak.	Medium		Establish a type scale. Apply consistently across all dashboard components.
Color Usage / Semantic Colors	Red is used for both the error alerts in 'Success Center' and critical notification states. No semantic color system exists — warning, info, and error look identical.	Medium		Define semantic color tokens error, warning, info, success. Apply consistently.
Multi-select UX	When 3 items are selected, the input field shows '+1' overflow with no indication of what the hidden item is. Users must open dropdown to recall selections.	Medium		On hover of '+1', show a tooltip listing hidden selections. Make '+1' chip clickable to scroll list to those items.
Platform Feature — Search	No global search exists anywhere. As employer accumulates candidates, messages, and job posts, there is no way to search — a serious scalability problem.	Medium		Add global search bar in top nav (cmd+K shortcut) that searches across candidates, messages, and job posts simultaneously. Results grouped by type.
Microcopy / CTA Labels	Both error items in Success Center use identical 'Take Action →' link text. Users cannot tell which action leads where, adding cognitive load.	Medium		Use descriptive CTA text specific to each action.
Navigation Structure	Logout sits in main sidebar nav alongside Dashboard and core features same visual weight as primary navigation. It is a destructive exit action one misclick away.	Medium		Remove Logout from primary nav. Move to user account dropdown in top nav. If kept in sidebar, visually demote it — smaller text, muted color, separator line above.
Accessibility	No focus rings or keyboard navigation states visible on any interactive element. This is a WCAG 2.1 AA compliance failure.	Medium		Add visible focus ring on all interactive elements and target WCAG AA.
Responsive Modal UX	On 425px, 'Add New Skill' modal doesn't properly handle long tag content. Tag 'Carpentry - Custom Woodworking' clips out of bounds inside the input area.	Medium		Improve tag overflow handling inside modal input by applying truncation, horizontal scrolling, or responsive wrapping. Ensure all modal content remains visible.
Responsive Alerts / Alignment	On tablet Success Center warning icons become visually top-heavy when adjacent body text wraps onto multiple lines. Icons appear detached from content block.	Medium		Vertically center alert icons relative to combined heading and body text block using flex alignment. Ensure multi-line alert layouts preserve visual balance.
Navigation Consistency	In mobile navigation drawer, 'Messages' item is missing its icon while every other nav item includes one. This breaks alignment consistency.	Medium		Add the missing message/mail icon and audit all navigation items for icon rendering consistency across every breakpoint and state.
Mobile Top Bar UX	On mobile, top bar only displays logo and hamburger menu. No user identity, avatar, account access, or notification context is visible.x	Medium		Introduce compact user avatar and notification bell in mobile top bar. Tapping avatar opens account actions (profile, settings, logout).
Icon Semantics	Wrench/spanner icon next to 'Trade categories we are matching you with' implies settings action, creating false affordance suggesting it is clickable.	Low		Replace with neutral tag/label icon or remove entirely. If kept, visually suppress it to signal it is decorative.
Navigation Structure	Main content area has no page-level header or breadcrumb. Users cannot confirm their location. Pattern won't scale once users navigate into sub-pages.	Low		Add a top bar with current page title on the left and utility actions (notifications, user avatar) on the right.
State Management / UX	Success Center card has no dismiss or 'done' mechanism. It will persist even after users complete the listed actions.	Low		Once items are completed, show card to success state with a Dismiss option. Have option to Dismiss the action proposed in Card
Form UX / Microcopy	Search input inside dropdown has no search icon and uninformative placeholder ('Search'). Input has no visible border in default state.	Low		Add search icon left of input.
Spacing / Mobile Safe Area	On Mobile the Safe space is same as that in Table and Laptop, which reduces real estate available for actual Content.	Low		Enforce a reduced horizontal padding on smaller displays